

From Local Pride to Global Markets

Stories of GI Triumph

Imagine a handwoven blanket from the Himalayas that shields against icy winds or a fiery chili from Mizoram, grown organically on fertile slopes. These Geographical Indications (GIs) are symbols of India's rich heritage and craftsmanship. With over 658 GIs now registered, India is redefining how local traditions can thrive in global markets, creating sustainable livelihoods and celebrating cultural excellence.

A Geographical Indication (GI) is an intellectual property right linking a product's unique qualities and reputation to its specific geographical origin. This connection ensures authenticity and protects the product's cultural and historical essence. Under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi and the guidance of Hon'ble Union Minister Shri Piyush Goyal, significant efforts have been undertaken to preserve and promote GI products globally. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has driven these initiatives, enhancing global recognition, fostering economic growth, and safeguarding India's unique traditions. This focused strategy has not only positioned India's GI products on the global stage but also created sustainable economic opportunities for local artisans and producers.

Authenticity Unleashed: India's GI Success Stories in Global Markets

With a rich legacy, India boasts over 658 registered GIs out of which 620 are Indian products showcasing its vast cultural wealth. These products not only symbolize regional diversity but also promote sustainable practices, preserving traditional knowledge and craftsmanship for future generations. From fiery spices to delectable sweets, these products are not just regional treasures but also global ambassadors of Indian excellence.

Let's explore the journey of some of the key GI-tagged success stories that are reshaping international markets while celebrating the rich traditions of India:

Uttarakhand Thulma:

Thulma is a traditional handwoven woolen blanket crafted by the indigenous Bhutiya community of Uttarakhand, nestled in the Himalayan region. Known for its exceptional warmth and durability, Thulma is a pure, hand-spun, and handwoven product made from wool, designed to withstand the extreme cold of high-altitude areas, where other woolen materials often fall short. Its unique hairy texture and soft bushiness make it a sought-after product for use in sub-zero temperatures.

This ethnic product, deeply rooted in the rich cultural heritage of the Himalayas, is a testament to the skill and artistry of the Bhutiya community, who have been weaving it for generations. The traditional weaving process, which involves hand-spinning wool into threads and weaving them on 4-pedaled pit looms, reflects the timeless craftsmanship of the region. Women play a significant role in this intricate process, contributing to both the preservation of